Faisal Isam

fisam@uoguelph.ca (905) 805-5010 GitHub LinkedIn

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Computing, Software Engineering (Co-op) - University of Guelph 09/2023 - 04/2027

- Dean's List (Fall 2023, Winter 2024, Fall 2024, Winter 2025), GPA: 3.7%
- Expected Minor in Mathematics
- Relevant Courses: Data Structures, Object-Oriented Programming, Discrete Structures, Software Design

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: C, C++, Python, JavaScript, Java, Excel, HTML/CSS, R
Tools: SQL, API/REST, Git/Github, React, Node, MongoDB, Gemini AI, Jira, Linux, Next, TailWindCSS
Skills: Artificial Intelligence, Knowledge of Agile and Waterfall methods

EXPERIENCE

Bioinformatics Analyst - Hanner Labs, University of Guelph 09/2025 - 12/2025

- Retrieved, processed, and curated large-scale DNA barcode datasets through the BOLD API, ensuring data integrity and consistency for biodiversity research projects.
- Developed and automated data handling workflows using R (tidyverse, dplyr) and Python (pandas), improving efficiency and reproducibility of dataset management.
- Created interactive and static maps of Canada using R (plotly) and Python (matplotlib, cartopy), enabling researchers to visualize species distributions and explore taxonomic patterns more efficiently.
- Built analytical dashboards and visual summaries to quantify and compare taxa presence near mine sites, helping researchers interpret complex datasets more efficiently.

PROJECTS

TripWise - JavaScript 07/2025 - 08/2025

- Designed to solve decision fatigue in travel planning by helping users quickly find personalized destinations and activities.
- Developed a full-stack web app using JavaScript and Gemini AI's API to generate AI-powered travel recommendations based on user preferences, budget, and travel dates.
    - Tools Used: React, JavaScript, Gemini AI, Node.js, Express.

vCard Parser - C/Python 01/2025 - 04/2025

- Engineered a high-performance backend parser in C to efficiently read and process complex vCard (.vcf) file structures, demonstrating strong systems-level programming skills.
- Built a dynamic graphical user interface using Python that allows users to upload VCF files, view parsed contact data, and manage entries.
- Designed and implemented an SQL database schema to store and retrieve structured contact records, ensuring data integrity and query optimization.
    - Tools Used: C Programming, Python, SQL

LEADERSHIP/INVOLVEMENT

Sheridan Hackville 01/2026

- Collaborated on a full-stack hackathon project to build a household management app with expense tracking, task management, user authentication, and API-driven architecture.